



June 25th 2019 Delaware County Council Meeting

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=K4_tSISXKLA
Publication Date	2019-06-26T17:03:12Z
Target Category	delaware_county

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1. Pre-Meeting Hearings & Committee Work Sessions

(No statutory public hearings or committee work sessions were held immediately prior to the call to order.)

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer calls the meeting to order **00:00:08**, followed by roll call **00:01:11**.
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Members identified by roll call as Alexander, Ballard, Chambers, Lassiter, Piper, and Ryan (note: specific roll call names span the transcript responses).
 - **Absent:** Not explicitly detailed.
 - **Presiding Officer:** Presided over by the Council President (referred to as Ron/President).

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** Roll call conducted; general opening procedures observed.
- **Approval of Minutes:** Motion made and seconded **00:01:35** to approve the minutes of the previous meeting. *Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote.*

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

- **00:02:12 Presentation: Sixth Circuit Court Proposal**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Judge Kim Dowling (Circuit Court 2).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Judge Dowling presented weighted caseload data for Delaware County circuit courts (1 through 5) and Muncie City Court. She explained that the state is looking to absorb city courts into state trial courts because city courts are not courts of record, creating duplicative appeals and higher costs. Delaware County currently ranks 10th in the state for the need of an additional court. The proposal seeks to establish a Sixth Circuit Court (space has already been made in the new building by commissioners). The initiative will be presented to the state legislative study council. The judges request a letter of support/acknowledgement from the Council stating that if the legislature approves the court, the county understands it will be locally funded.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** No formal vote taken; consensus reached to have the attorney draft a letter for future council consideration.
- **00:13:58 Fund Transfers & Line Item Adjustments**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Department heads and Finance/Emily.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Review and processing of various departmental budget transfers, salary ordinance adjustments, and line-item corrections:
 - Health Insurance / Computer Upgrades (**00:14:08**): Approved by Voice Vote.
 - Commissioner Chambers (**00:15:15**): Insurance adjustments. *Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote.*
 - Probation Office (**00:16:05**): Positions renamed/transferred (Chief Probation Officer / Adult Probation Officer line items). *Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote.*
 - Court 3 (**00:17:44**): Line item transfers. *Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote.*
 - Election Board (**00:18:22**): Precinct workers and legal services. *Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote.*
 - EMS (**00:18:59**): Discussion regarding staffing shortages, high turnover, retention issues, and comparison with surrounding municipal pay rates (e.g., Anderson, Westfield, Carmel). *Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote (00:28:28).*
 - Commissioners / Management (**00:28:28**): Office manager retirement replacement (25 years service). *Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote.*
 - Public Defender (**00:30:14**): Salary adjustments from attorney fees to court-ordered counsel to pay outside contract attorneys due to state caseload caps and murder trial conflicts. *Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote (00:36:34).*
 - Sheriff Department (**00:36:47**): Transfers. *Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote.*

- Community Corrections (00:37:27): Assistant executive director stipend and case manager adjustments. *Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote (00:38:02).*
 - Jail (00:39:06): Correction officer line adjustments. *Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote (00:43:00).*
 - Health Department (00:40:14): Environmental position adjustments. *Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote.*
 - Miscellaneous fund adjustments and salary ordinance amendments. *Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote (00:43:58).*
 - 00:44:11 **Job Description Approval: Community Corrections Assistant Executive Director**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Jane Randolph (Community Corrections).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a new job description/title change to designate an existing supervisor as an Assistant Executive Director to handle duties in the Director's absence, utilizing a stipend structure vetted through HR.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion to approve job description as presented. *Disposition: Approved by Voice Vote (00:50:55).*
 - 00:51:48 **Endorsement of Commissioners' Purchase of Mulberry Street Building**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Council President / David.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussion regarding a long-term lease agreement for the building at 117<U+2013>125 North Mulberry Street (housing the Health Department) expiring September 30, 2019. The lease agreement stipulates that the commissioners can purchase the building for \$1 at the end of the lease.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Motion made and seconded to endorse the commissioners purchasing the building for one dollar. *Passed Unanimously by Voice Vote (00:55:07).*
 - 00:57:23 **Presentation: County Tax Deed Sale Update**
 - **Sponsor / Presenter:** Make Carole (County Treasurer) & Melanie Marshall (County Recorder).
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Presentation on the success of the county's first "Deed Sale" under new Indiana statutes. The sale drew over 400-500 attendees and generated over \$100,000 in net revenue, plus approximately \$35,000 annually in restored tax collections. Unlike traditional tax sales requiring a 12-month wait and quiet title suits, the deed sale transfers property and possession immediately, boosting interest from real estate associations and neighborhood groups. 141 deeds were successfully recorded.
 - **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
 - **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; no board action required.
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5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:06:47 Molly Hunt (Purdue Extension):** Provided a monthly report update, distributed flyers for an upcoming July adolescent substance abuse program, and introduced Lindsay Cox as the new Community Wellness Coordinator.
- **01:08:02 Ashley Religio, Caroline Bromley, and Cambree Lynch (4-H Youth Representatives & Junior Leaders):** Provided updates on 4-H youth development programs, "Teens as Teachers" outreach initiatives, communication improvements using GroupMe, and thanked the council for their ongoing support of 4-H.
- **01:14:59 Melanie Marshall (Delaware County Fair Board):** Invited council members and the public to the Delaware County Fair running July 10th through July 20th, noting that 4-H events begin on July 10th. Also highlighted the 4-H July 4th fireworks parking fundraiser to support fairground equipment.
- **01:17:03 Councilmember Report (Washington D.C. Fly-In):** Shared experiences attending the 2019 Washington D.C. fly-in with the ECI Regional Planning District, meeting with federal agencies (DOT, EPA, DOJ) and congressional representatives (Senators Braun and Young, Rep. Brooks, Rep. Pence, Rep. Baird), noting federal enthusiasm for local infrastructure and the aquaculture farm in Albany.

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:**
 - Board members paid tribute to fallen local EMS paramedics and discussed broader systemic challenges regarding EMS burnout, low retention, and shift hours.
 - Mentioned upcoming Association of Indiana Counties (AIC) conference in September and potential application for Delaware County recognition.
 - Discussed state legislative funding changes for community and mental health.
 - Noted the transition of county bookkeeping systems toward accrual-based accounting to comply with state mandates for bond readiness.
 - Expressed condolences regarding the passing of former Commissioner Sam.
- **Adjournment:** Meeting adjourned following final motions and voice votes [kl. [01:35:33](#)].